JavaScript

JavaScript lets programmers create user-friendly interactive webpages. It also allows them to add animations, or change a website's layout when viewed on smartphones.

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Background

In the early 1990s, users couldn't interact with webpages beyond reading them. Websites were often created by amateur programmers who were interested in the new technology, or by designers whose background was in art. JavaScript was designed to enable these users to add interactive elements to their pages. The name "JavaScript" was largely a marketing strategy. Java was very popular and JavaScript's creators hoped the association would be advantageous.

```
public class HelloWorld {
   public static void main(String[] args) {
      System.out.println("Hello, World!");
   }
}
```

Java

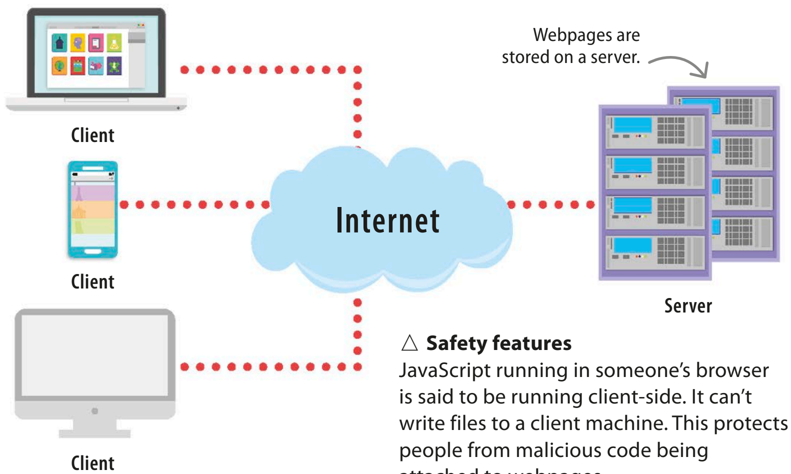
```
function helloworld() {
    alert("Hello, World !");
}
```

JavaScript

▷ **Different from Java**
Though you might expect them to be related, Java and JavaScript are different languages, seen here in their "Hello, World!" code.

How does it work?

A JavaScript program is usually called a script. It's associated with a particular webpage and runs whenever someone loads the page in a browser. JavaScript is interpreted, not compiled, similar to Python. It's predominantly an object-oriented language, but looks quite similar to C as it uses curly brackets and semicolons.



△ **Safety features**
JavaScript running in someone's browser is said to be running client-side. It can't write files to a client machine. This protects people from malicious code being attached to webpages.

REAL WORLD

Pop-ups

One of JavaScript's least popular applications may be pop-up dialogue boxes. Pop-ups block the browser window and require the user to interact with them. They range from being a mild annoyance that interrupts the browsing experience to redirecting users towards malware and other online scams.